

The Other Turnout

100+
The number of nominations in three of Telangana's 119 constituencies*

101
were in the fray in Kamareddy, where KCR is up against not just Congress's Revanth Reddy but scores of angry jobless youth

154
nominations in Gajwel, KCR's other seat, of the 200+ protest candidates

**some of the 'candidates' in these seats have since been persuaded to drop out*

Jat vs Jatni

Patriarchy still flows from the muzzle of a hookah, when it comes to Jats. In Rajasthan, Divya Maderna, 39, sitting Congress MLA and Osian hopeful, has been getting it from maverick MP Hanuman Beniwal, founder of the Rashtriya Loktantrik Party. Why does she not get married, he intoned in avuncular fashion, and said only that would help calm her down. He even promised to get her married for the sake of the community. The twist of the knife? Allusions to the infamous CD of her late father, ex-minister Mahipal Maderna, who spent a decade in jail in the Bhanwari Devi murder case. Divya, no shrinking violet, gives it right back. For all that, Beniwal has fielded no one against her. ■



ubiquitous 'drawing room on wheels'? The more resourceful ones, like A. Indrakaran Reddy (Nirmal) and Kova Laxmi (Asifabad), are importing the cars from Maharashtra. For a flourish, they get the old jalopy painted in the party colour—bright pink, if you please. Embossed portraits of the candidates and, of course, of KCR add to the subtlety. ■

-By **Rahul Noronha, Rohit Parihar and Amarnath K. Menon**

Raja Betas



The Pandavas? Well, not quite...but five sons of former CMs are in the fight in Madhya Pradesh. Each with interesting links to the other, political and personal. Ajay Singh, son of Arjun Singh, is married to the first cousin of Jai Vardhan Singh, son of Digvijaya Singh. Both Ajay and Jai are Congress candidates. Om Prakash Saklecha, scion of the '70s-vintage CM Virendra Kumar Saklecha, has a BJP ticket to ride. So has Dhruv Narayan Singh, the progeny of the more deeply sepia-tinted Govind Narayan Singh, a Congress émigré who got to be a coalition government's CM in the '60s, with the Jan Sanghi Saklecha as his deputy. Deepak Joshi, the ex-MLA and minister whose saffron pedigree also flows from Eastmancolor-era dad Kailash Joshi, is mounted on a Congress steed this time. This is not counting Surendra Patwa, 'adopted son' of his issue-less uncle Sunderlal Patwa and in the fray from old haunt Bhojpur. ■